



WSJ

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL WEEKEND



What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Biden blocked** the sale of U.S. Steel to Japan's Nippon Steel, fulfilling his pledge to keep the storied steelmaker domestically owned. **A1**
- ◆ **The auto industry** is on track to report that it eked out a small increase in U.S. vehicle sales for 2024, helped by better availability on the new-car lot and a flurry of promotional deals in recent months. **B9**
- ◆ **U.S. stocks jumped** with the Dow, S&P 500 and Nasdaq gaining 0.8%, 1.3% and 1.8%, respectively. Each sector of the S&P logged gains. **B11**
- ◆ **Boeing is conducting** more surprise inspections at its factories as part of a broader plan to prevent manufacturing snafus. **B9**
- ◆ **JetBlue Airways** has agreed to pay a \$2 million penalty after the U.S. Transportation Department found it had operated chronically delayed flights in 2022 and 2023. **B9**
- ◆ **An Asian-American** venture-capital investor has sued PayPal, accusing the company of illegal discrimination by earmarking \$100 million in investments for Black- and Latino-owned investment funds. **B9**
- ◆ **Bayer said** the Federal Court of Australia closed the last pending case in the country over whether its Roundup weedkiller causes cancer. **B10**

World-Wide

- ◆ **A New York judge** in a surprise move said he would sentence Trump for his hush-money conviction before the president-elect begins his second term in the White House, but made clear that a prison term wasn't a possibility. **A1**
- ◆ **Incumbent Mike Johnson** (R., La.) won re-election as speaker of the House on the first ballot, after two hold-out Republicans changed their votes and handed him the narrow majority needed to claim the gavel. **A1**
- ◆ **The U.S. surgeon general** said alcoholic beverages should carry cancer warnings to increase awareness that the drinks are a leading cause of preventable cancers. **A1**
- ◆ **Researchers have identified** the gut as a focus for forces they suspect of driving up cancer cases in the young. **A3**
- ◆ **Biden is planning** to ban oil and gas drilling in certain federal waters in the Atlantic and Pacific oceans using a law that could make it difficult for Trump to reverse. **A6**
- ◆ **South Korean investigators** failed to arrest impeached President Yoon Suk Yeol, thwarted by his armed Secret Service bodyguards. **A8**
- ◆ **A planned overhaul** of Syria's education curriculum is spurring concerns about the new government's assurances that it will rebuild an inclusive society. **A9**

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Signposts on the wisdom trail **A13**

CONTENTS

Markets & Fin.....	B11		
Books.....	C7-12		
Opinion.....	A11-13		
Business & Fin. B9-10	Sports.....	A14	
Design & Decor.....	D9	Style & Fashion	D2-3
Food.....	D7-8	Travel.....	D4
Gear & Gadgets.....	D6	U.S. News.....	A2-6
Heard on Street.....	B12	World News.....	A8-9

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Judge Hints No Jail for Trump

By CORINNE RAMEY

A New York judge in a surprise move Friday said he would sentence Donald Trump for his hush-money conviction before the president-elect begins his second term in the White House, but made clear that a prison term wasn't a possibility.

State Supreme Court Justice Juan Merchan said he would

sentence Trump next Friday, rejecting the former and future president's argument that the verdict couldn't remain in place after his re-election. Manhattan prosecutors had agreed to postpone the sentencing until after Trump's second term or even never hold the proceeding, both of which the judge rejected.

"Finding no legal impediment to sentencing and recog-

nizing that Presidential immunity will likely attach once Defendant takes his Oath of Office, it is incumbent upon this Court to set this matter down for the imposition of sentence prior to January 20, 2025," Merchan wrote in an 18-page decision.

The judge said he wasn't inclined to send Trump to jail, and that an unconditional discharge—or a sentence without

any punishment—was "the most viable solution to ensure finality and allow Defendant to pursue his appellate options."

Merchan said that Trump could appear for his sentencing, which will be held in state court in Manhattan, either virtually or in person.

The New York prosecution made Trump the first former

Please turn to page A6



Mike Johnson confers with GOP colleagues Jeff Van Drew, left, and Tim Burchett in the House chamber before his re-election as speaker on Friday. Johnson won on the first ballot after two of three Republican holdouts switched their votes.

Johnson Survives Speaker Vote After GOP Holdouts Give Way

WASHINGTON—Rep. Mike Johnson (R., La.) won re-election as speaker of the House

By Lindsay Wise, Xavier Martinez and Natalie Andrews

on the first ballot, after President-elect Donald Trump pressured Republican holdouts to change their votes, handing

Johnson the narrow majority needed to claim the gavel.

Johnson's dramatic victory clears the way for Republicans to charge headlong into Trump's second term, taking on an ambitious agenda of tax cuts and border security. While Johnson avoided a repeat of the GOP's calamitous January 2023 speaker vote, the tally underscored how little room

Johnson has to maneuver with the party's razor-thin margin. It also showed the power of any small group of dissidents to derail the party's plans.

"Working together, we have the potential to be one of the most consequential congresses in the history of this great nation," Johnson said.

The chain of events viewed how Trump and John-

son will need to move in lockstep to get legislation across the finish line and tamp down dissent, even though the party controls both chambers of Congress and the White House. While Trump was annoyed with Johnson over his handling

Please turn to page A4

◆ **Analysis: GOP has little room for error.....** A4

Biden Blocks U.S. Steel Takeover

Japan's Nippon must scrap its \$14.1 billion purchase after Cfius security-risk review

By BOB TITA AND CATHERINE LUCEY

President Biden blocked the sale of U.S. Steel to Japan's Nippon Steel, fulfilling his pledge to keep the storied steelmaker domestically owned.

Biden's decision comes after the Committee on Foreign Investment in the U.S., a federal interagency panel, spent months reviewing the \$14.1 billion deal for potential national-security risks. In an order Friday, the White House required the companies to abandon the deal within 30 days unless Cfius agrees to extend the timeline.

"We need major U.S. companies representing the major share of U.S. steelmaking capacity to keep leading the fight on behalf of America's national interests," Biden said.

Nippon Steel is the world's fourth-largest steelmaker. It had pursued U.S. Steel as a way to enter the American market, where tariffs have helped keep prices higher than in other parts of the world.

In a joint statement, the companies said the president's order didn't present any "credible evidence of a national security issue" and criticized the committee's review of the deal. Nippon Steel has said it plans to challenge the decision on due process grounds.

"Instead of abiding by the law, the process was manipulated to advance President Biden's political agenda," the companies said.

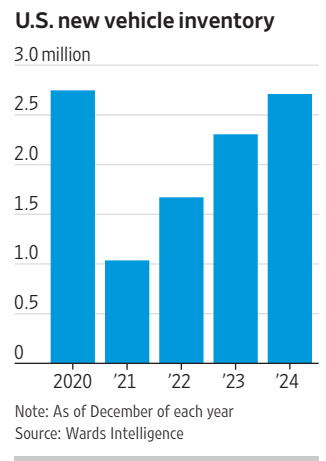
Shares in U.S. Steel closed Friday down nearly 7% to \$30.47, while American depositary receipts of Nippon Steel

Please turn to page A6

◆ **Biden to ban drilling in coastal waters.....** A6

Automakers Log Sales Rise

Several carmakers' results improved in late 2024, as inventory improved. **B9**



Surgeon General Seeks Alcohol Cancer Label

By LAURA COOPER AND BRIANNA ABBOTT

The U.S. surgeon general said alcoholic beverages should carry cancer warnings to increase awareness that the drinks are a leading cause of preventable cancers.

An act of Congress would be required to change the existing warning labels on bottles of beer, wine and liquor. Today, federal rules require only a warning against drunken driving and drinking while pregnant, as well as a general warning that alcohol "may cause health problems."

"Alcohol is a well-established, preventable cause of cancer responsible for about 100,000 cases of cancer and 20,000 cancer deaths annually in the United States," Dr. Vivek Murthy said in his advisory issued Friday. "Yet the majority of Americans are unaware of this risk."

Shares of beer and spirits companies such as Anheuser-Busch InBev and Diageo fell in Friday trading. The Beer Institute, which represents big

Please turn to page A2

◆ **Focus on young people's cancer turns to gut.....** A3

In Two Attacks, Unraveling Lives And Mysteries

New Orleans and Las Vegas grapple with aftermath of deadly incidents

By JOSHUA CHAFFIN AND SCOTT CALVERT

It was New Year's Eve and Shamsud-Din Jabbar, a Houston veteran whose life was coming apart, climbed into a rented pickup truck and drove east toward New Orleans.

As he made his way across the Gulf Coast swampland, the native-born Jabbar simultaneously recorded a series of videos he would soon post to social media in which he swore his allegiance to Islamic State and declared his intention to commit mass murder.

The city he found at the end of his journey was heaving. Fireworks illuminated the sky over the Mississippi at midnight. On Bourbon Street, where locals joke there is no such thing as "last call," revelers were packed shoulder-to-shoulder, throwing back hurricanes and daiquiris. The New Year's Eve party had been supersized by the Sugar Bowl New Orleans was hosting the next day between two of

America's most storied college football teams, Notre Dame and the University of Georgia.

At 2:03 a.m., with the party in full swing, surveillance footage showed a serious-looking Jabbar, 42, salt-and-pepper in his hair, walking along Dauphine Street. He was wearing a long brown overcoat and glasses, and appeared to be holding a phone or a wallet.

Soon, he was light in the truck, a Ford F-150 Lightning with a black-and-white ISIS flag flying from the back. At around 3:15 a.m., he would turn off Canal Street, slipping through a gap in security, and then roar down Bourbon Street into the heart of the party, mangling bodies as he went. The rampage ended only when police killed him in a firefight a few blocks away

Please turn to page A10

◆ **New Orleans looks to rebound.....** A10

◆ **Safety questions arise for car-sharing app.....** B10

A Boom for Books on Bloodletting And Delivering Babies in 1669

Collectors with a love of medical history are bidding up the price of arcane texts

By JARED S. HOPKINS

Tim Opler was searching an online jewelry auction for a birthday gift for his wife when he stumbled upon something more interesting.

The New York investment banker

spent the next few hours scanning rare medical books and scooped up about 20 that piqued his interest. Since that day three years ago, he has acquired hundreds more, which he displays on shelves in his Manhattan office.

Please turn to page A2

EXCHANGE



HIDDEN FIGURE

The most indispensable machine in the world depends on this woman. **B1**